

slightly recessed, and both voices and instruments can get lost in complex mixes, making the overall presentation feel congested. The highs are clean but lack enough presence.

There is a 3D Spatial Audio mode in the QCY app that slightly widens the sound, which some may prefer over the default profile. In the Settings section, you'll find a Gaming Mode also which activates 60ms low-latency transmission. It can make a perceivable difference while watching video podcasts and playing games. For zero latency, you can always plug in the bundled 3.5mm aux cable. Noice!

Besides just the sound, noise cancellation is a sought-after feature on modern headphones. So let's see how QCY handles that:

AMBIENT NOISE CANCELLATION AND CALL QUALITY

The ANC performance of the H3 Pro is commendable. It claims to cancel up to 50 dB of noise. I tried the headphones indoors in an office space and on a busy street, and compared them to the best in the business: Sony WH-1000XM6. The results were quite close.

On the other hand, the Transparency/Ambient Sound mode lets you hear and be aware of your surroundings. It isn't as comfortable or natural-sounding as the XM6, but the comparison in itself is rather unfair.



Call quality via the 3-mic ENC setup is decent. Both parties in the call could hear each other properly.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

The rated battery is up to 55 hours with ANC off, and around 40+ hours with ANC on. With ANC on and LDAC on, I could get close to those claims in our continuous playback test.

Charging by USB-C took about 1 hour and 30 minutes for the device to fill 100 percent. Not bad

After all, the battery life is long enough that you don't have to bear the anxiety of charging it often.

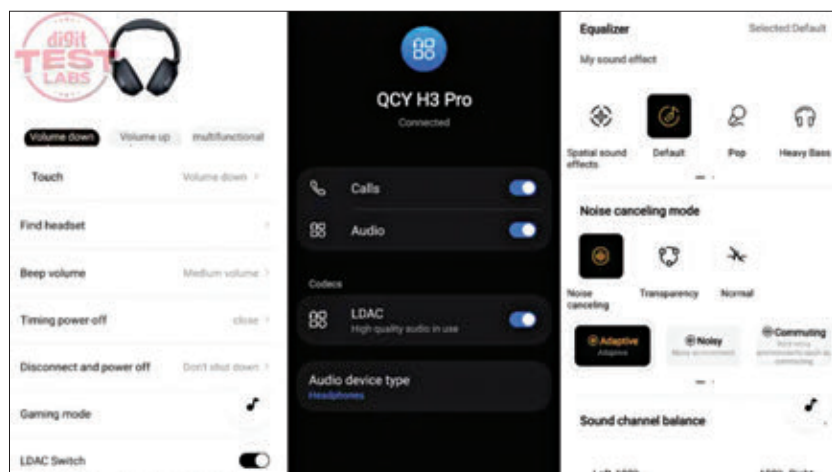
VERDICT

The QCY H3 Pro stands out very much for packing features like LDAC codec support, adaptive ANC up to 50 dB, Bluetooth 5.4 with multipoint connectivity, and a 55-hour battery life, all in a lightweight foldable build with IPX4 splash resistance. It delivers strong value for money, offering premium-tier functions at a budget price.

The audio quality, while decent, is definitely not perfect: the volume is low by default, vocals sound slightly recessed, and the bass lacks depth as well. The app experience feels pretty unpolished, too, with poor translations and having the limitation of not being able to use LDAC codec and multipoint connectivity simultaneously.

Under Rs 4,000, you may find other options like the boAt Rockerz 551 ANC Pro or the Sennheiser HD 400s or th HAMMER Bash Pro, but they simply lack the advanced codecs and features that the QCY H3 Pro gives you. So, the QCY H3 Pro still makes more sense for users who want a portable headphone that looks decent enough, has a long battery life, gives strong noise cancellation, and who can accept minor compromises in app design and sound refinement in exchange for the feature set it offers. If you are that person, you should definitely check out the QCY H3 Pro Headphones on Amazon India for a price of Rs 3,999.

—G. S. Vasan



SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 40mm Dynamic Titanium | Codec: LSAC, AAC, SBC | Frequency Response: 20Hz-40kHz | ANC: Yes, Adaptive | Mics: 3 Mic system | Dimensions: 160.2 mm × 81.7 mm × 196.8 mm | Weight: 231g | Battery: 550 mAh | Charging: Type-C wired / 2 hrs for full charge | Connectivity: Bluetooth 5.4/wired

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